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Dubai Rapid Properties

MARKET INSIGHTS · DUBAI

Dubai Residential Market Report

Q3 2026 · JULY – SEPTEMBER

AED 73.9bn	33,969	6.3%
SALES VALUE	HOMES SOLD	AVG. GROSS YIELD

PREPARED BY DUBAI RAPID PROPERTIES



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WELCOME

A word from our Founder & CEO

Summer is usually the slowest stretch of the year in Dubai real estate, and Q3 2026 was no exception. Yet by September the city was busy again: residents were back, viewings picked up and our daily conversations with buyers became noticeably more active.

The headline numbers remain strong. Almost 34,000 homes changed hands in the quarter, worth AED 73.9 billion. What stood out for us was the return of the ready market: sales of completed homes rose by almost 15% on the previous quarter, as buyers looked for homes they can move into or rent out straight away.

Off-plan still accounts for most transactions, but buyers are more selective than a year ago. They compare developers, delivery records, pricing and payment plans far more carefully, which is healthy for a market that has grown as quickly as Dubai's.

Since 2007, Dubai Rapid Properties has guided clients through every phase of this market. Our advice today is simple: look at the quality, location and fundamentals of each individual property rather than the market as a whole. That is where long-term value is created.

Whether you are buying your first home, building a portfolio or looking for a reliable rental return, we are ready to help you find the right opportunity.

Jasko Miletic
Founder & CEO, Dubai Rapid Properties



Jasko Miletic
FOUNDER & CEO, DUBAI RAPID PROPERTIES

MARKET OVERVIEW

Q3 2026 at a glance

Dubai's residential market stayed busy through the summer. Activity was slower than in the first half of the year, which is typical for the season, but deals continued across every property type and price point.

Population growth keeps demand strong. Dubai reached around 4.8 million residents by the end of September, more than 226,000 more than in January, supporting both sales and rentals.

Buyers have more choice and take more time to decide. We see this as the natural next step for a fast-growing market, where the quality of each community and project matters more than ever.

RESIDENTIAL SALES VALUE **AED 73.9bn** Q3 2026	HOMES SOLD **33,969** Apartments, villas, townhouses	SALES ABOVE AED 10M **782** Luxury segment
OFF-PLAN SHARE **71.7%** Of all sales	HOMES RENTED **173,076** New leases and renewals	AVERAGE GROSS YIELD **6.3%** All property types

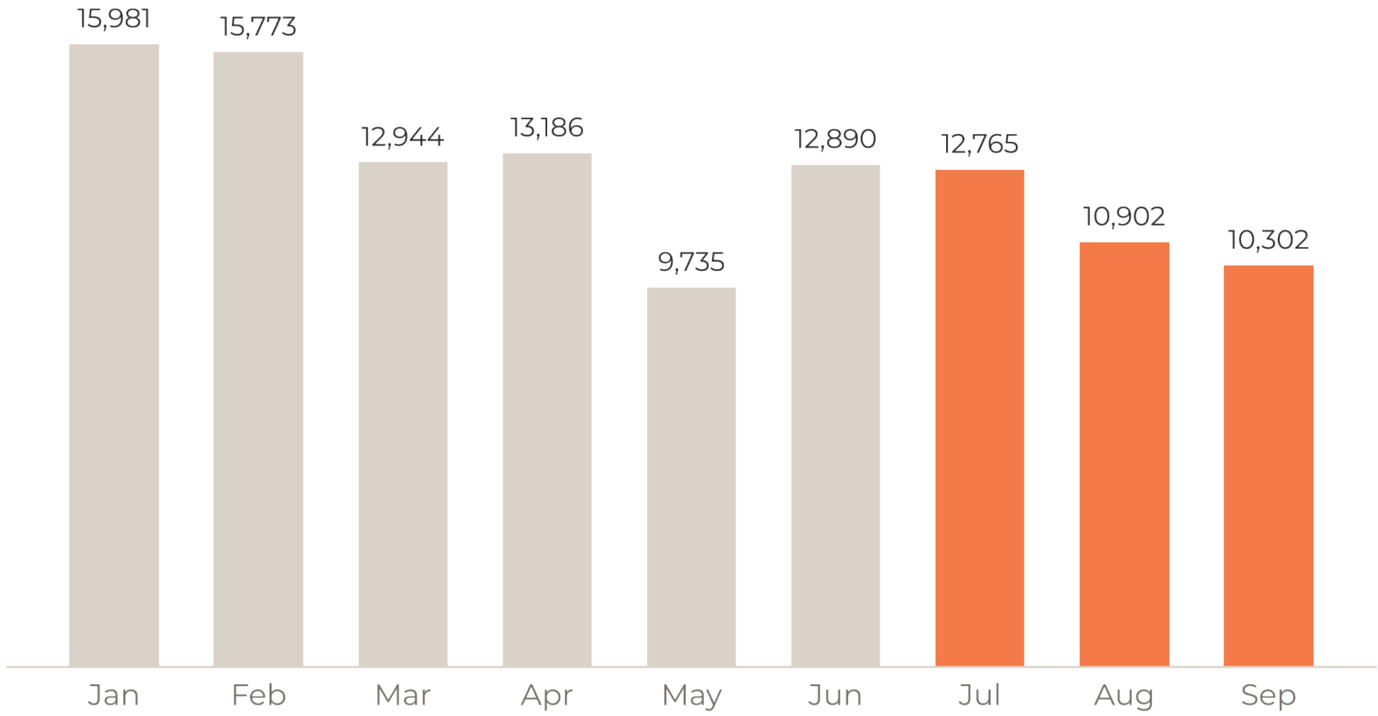
Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

RESIDENTIAL SALES

33,969 homes sold in Q3

- Sales slowed in line with the summer season but remained substantial, worth AED 73.9 billion in total and continuing the more measured pace seen in Q2.
- The ready market gained ground: completed-home sales rose from 8,547 in Q2 to 9,811 in Q3, up almost 15%, helped by fewer new off-plan launches.
- Activity moved towards more affordable homes: 40.1% of sales were below AED 1 million (29.1% in H1), 71.3% below AED 2 million and 84.3% below AED 3 million.
- Studios and one-bedroom apartments made up almost two-thirds of all sales. In the villa segment, ready sales outnumbered off-plan sales.

MONTHLY RESIDENTIAL SALES, 2026

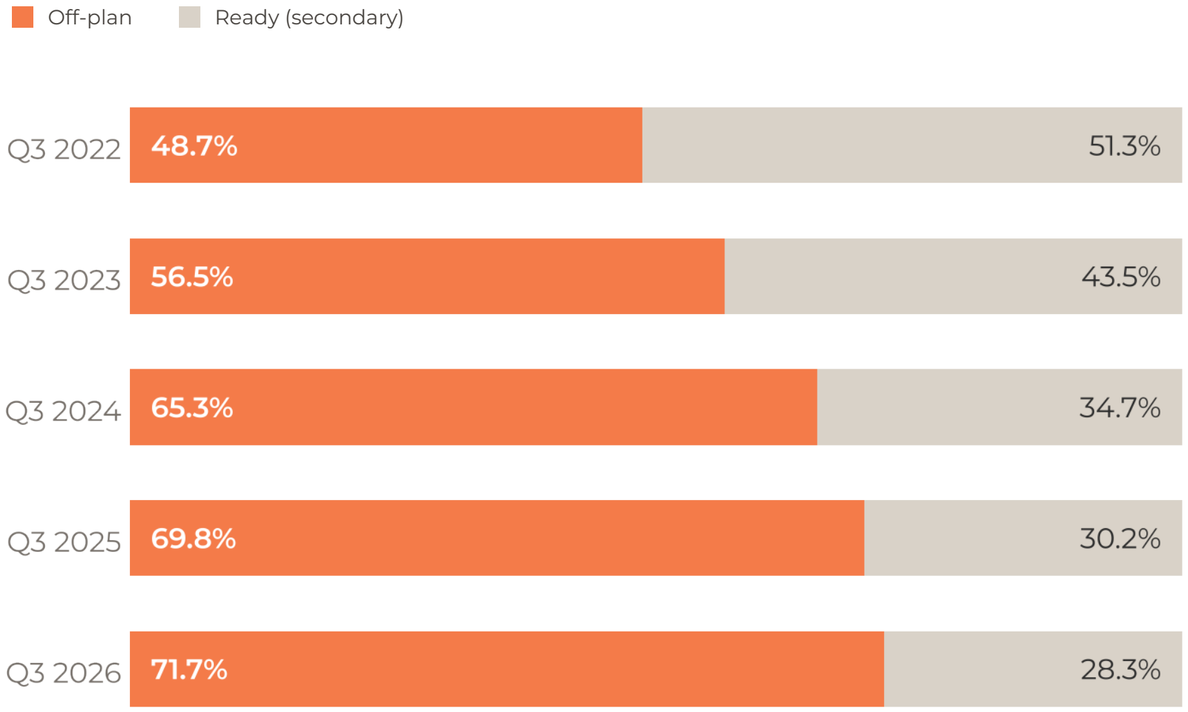


Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

OFF-PLAN VS READY

Off-plan leads, ready is catching up

SHARE OF SALES, Q3 2022 – Q3 2026



Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

TRANSACTION VALUE, Q3 2026

AED 46.9bn
Off-plan

AED 27.0bn
Ready

SALES BY PROPERTY TYPE

TYPE	OFF-PLAN	READY
Apartments	22,319	7,452
Townhouses	1,640	1,503
Villas	431	624

87.6%

Apartments made up 87.6% of all sales, townhouses 9.3% and villas 3.1%.

PRICE AND SIZE MIX

Where buyers are spending

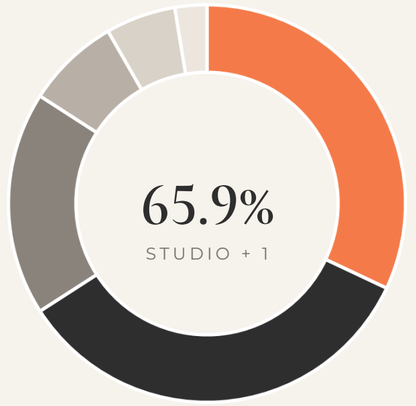
SALES BY PRICE BRACKET, Q3 2026

PRICE (AED)	ALL SALES	OFF-PLAN	READY
Below 1M	40.1%	43.2%	31.8%
1M – 2M	31.2%	32.5%	28.0%
2M – 3M	13.0%	11.9%	16.6%
3M – 5M	9.3%	7.3%	14.6%
5M – 10M	4.1%	3.3%	5.8%
Above 10M	2.2%	1.8%	3.2%

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

Two-thirds of buyers chose studios or one-bedroom homes, while the ready market had a larger share of homes above AED 3 million.

SALES BY NUMBER OF BEDROOMS



Studio	32.0%	1 bed	33.9%
2 beds	18.2%	3 beds	7.6%
4 beds	5.7%	5+ beds	2.6%

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AVERAGE SALES PRICES

Price per sq ft by community

Prices moved differently from one community to the next. Apartment values were broadly stable in established areas, with small declines in some, while villa communities generally performed better, led by Palm Jumeirah, Jumeirah Golf Estates and The Meadows.

COMMUNITY	TYPE	AED / SQ FT	CHANGE VS Q3 2025
Palm Jumeirah	Villa	8,792	+31.3%
Jumeirah Islands	Villa	4,678	+8.8%
The Meadows	Villa	3,246	+10.8%
Dubai Hills Estate	Villa	2,512	−10.0%
Downtown Dubai	Apartment	2,497	−0.5%
Palm Jumeirah	Apartment	2,448	−3.7%
Dubai Hills Estate	Apartment	2,248	−0.9%
The Springs	Villa	2,231	+6.9%
Arabian Ranches	Villa	2,188	+3.9%
Jumeirah Golf Estates	Villa	2,038	+12.4%
Dubai Marina	Apartment	1,883	+5.7%
Business Bay	Apartment	1,813	+3.3%
DAMAC Hills	Villa	1,786	+4.5%
Jumeirah Beach Residence	Apartment	1,550	−8.6%
Jumeirah Village Circle	Apartment	1,259	−0.7%

Villa figures include townhouses.

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

RENTAL YIELDS

6.3%

AVERAGE GROSS RENTAL YIELD, Q3 2026

6.6%	5.1%	4.4%
Apartments	Townhouses	Villas

Apartments still deliver the highest average returns. Yields have eased slightly since the start of the year but remain competitive with most major global cities.

MATCHING THE PROPERTY TO THE GOAL

Apartments	Higher yields, lower entry price
Townhouses	A balance of income and growth
Villas	Lower yields, stronger capital growth

GROSS YIELD BY COMMUNITY, SEPTEMBER 2026

COMMUNITY	APARTMENTS	VILLAS
Dubai South	**7.2%**	4.8%
DAMAC Hills	**7.2%**	5.3%
Arjan	**6.9%**	–
Jumeirah Village Triangle	**6.7%**	3.5%
Jumeirah Lake Towers	**6.5%**	–
Jumeirah Golf Estates	**6.4%**	5.8%
Jumeirah Village Circle	**6.3%**	4.5%
Business Bay	**5.9%**	–
Dubai Hills Estate	**5.8%**	4.7%
Palm Jumeirah	**4.6%**	3.6%

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

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LUXURY MARKET

Prime demand stays strong

782
Homes sold above AED 10M

AED 16.9bn
Value of AED 10M+ sales

22.8%
Share of total sales value

Palm Jumeirah was again among the most active prime communities, joined by Jumeirah Golf Estates 2, Palm Jebel Ali, Tilal Al Ghaf and The Oasis. Several homes sold for more than AED 100 million, across both ready and off-plan property, showing how far Dubai's luxury market now reaches beyond its traditional core.

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)



LUXURY MARKET

Top sales of the quarter

APARTMENT · READY

AED 40M

4 bedrooms

Six Senses The Palm, Palm Jumeirah

VILLA · READY

AED 252M

7 bedrooms

Dubai Hills View, Dubai Hills Estate

TOWNHOUSE · READY

AED 31M

4 bedrooms

Villa Amalfi, Jumeirah Bay Island

APARTMENT · OFF-PLAN

AED 166M

5 bedrooms

Aman Residences, Jumeirah 2

VILLA · OFF-PLAN

AED 91M

8 bedrooms

Lanai Island, Tilal Al Ghaf

TOWNHOUSE · OFF-PLAN

AED 13M

4 bedrooms

The Villa Collection, Lunaya

MOST ACTIVE PRIME COMMUNITIES

COMMUNITY	AED 10M+ SALES
Palm Jumeirah	67
Jumeirah Golf Estates 2	62
Palm Jebel Ali	39
Tilal Al Ghaf	38
Downtown Dubai	37
The Oasis	34
Business Bay	31
Dubai Harbour	30
Dubai Hills Estate	30
Jumeirah Golf Estates	29

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

RENTAL MARKET

A busy leasing quarter

AED 15.6bn — Total rental value

173,076 — Homes rented

AED 90,200 — Average annual rent

- Rental transactions rose 23.5% on Q2 as residents returned after the summer and the population kept growing.
- New contracts made up 45.3% of deals, up from 36.2% in Q2, as tenants moved to take advantage of more choice.
- Apartments accounted for 89% of all leases, and one- and two-bedroom homes for almost two-thirds.

RENTS BY PROPERTY SIZE, Q3 2026

SIZE	CONTRACTS	AVG. ANNUAL RENT
Studio	31,179	**AED 40,698**
1 bedroom	65,691	**AED 62,094**
2 bedrooms	48,256	**AED 92,477**
3 bedrooms	18,328	**AED 155,897**
4 bedrooms	6,287	**AED 262,435**
5 bedrooms	1,985	**AED 414,722**

CONTRACTS



Renewals 54.7% New 45.3%

PROPERTY TYPE



Apartments 89.0% Villas 5.8% Townhouses 5.2%

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)



AVERAGE RENTS

Annual rents by community

The average home in Dubai rented for AED 90,200 a year in Q3. Prime villa communities such as Palm Jumeirah and Jumeirah Golf Estates command the highest rents, while JVC, JVT and DAMAC Hills offer the most accessible apartments.

COMMUNITY	APARTMENTS (AED)	VILLAS (AED)
Palm Jumeirah	233,069	**1,653,738**
Jumeirah Golf Estates	118,889	**652,028**
Dubai Hills Estate	128,146	**425,652**
Tilal Al Ghaf	–	**333,317**
Arabian Ranches	–	**314,197**
DAMAC Hills	63,774	**227,998**
The Springs	–	**202,077**
Jumeirah Village Triangle	66,356	**178,032**
Downtown Dubai	161,975	–
Dubai Marina	119,956	–
Business Bay	99,524	–
Jumeirah Lake Towers	90,610	–
Jumeirah Village Circle	67,824	–

Source: Property Monitor (Dubai Land Department transaction data)

Mortgages

Mortgage finance kept supporting the market. The UAE Central Bank raised its base rate by 0.25 percentage points in September, in line with the US Federal Reserve, and some banks adjusted their pricing.

Fixed rates remain competitive and banks are still keen to lend, although terms vary widely between lenders. With many cash buyers in Dubai, higher borrowing costs do not affect the whole market equally.

Comparing lenders and choosing the right fixed term can make a real difference to the total cost of a purchase.

Outlook for Q4

Dubai enters the final quarter of 2026 with renewed energy. After a quiet summer, we expect activity to pick up as the busier year-end season begins and developers bring more projects to market.

We see a period of stabilisation and greater differentiation rather than a broad correction. Established developers with strong delivery records, and projects with a genuinely distinctive location, product or price, are best placed.

The World Bank forecasts UAE economic growth of 9.5% in 2027, after an expected 1.6% contraction in 2026, largely reflecting the recovery of oil production.

Quality, location and long-term value will define the strongest opportunities, in both off-plan and ready property.



ABOUT THIS REPORT

Your partner in Dubai real estate

Since 2007, Dubai Rapid Properties has helped buyers, investors and tenants across Dubai with off-plan and ready sales, leasing, holiday home management and investment advice.

If you are considering a purchase, an investment or a rental, speak to us before you decide. We will help you compare communities, projects and payment plans, and find the property that fits your goals.

WHAT WE DO

- Off-plan and ready sales
- Leasing and property management
- D|R|P Holiday Homes
- Investment advice

METHODOLOGY

Figures cover residential sales and rental transactions registered with the Dubai Land Department between July and September 2026, as published through the Property Monitor platform. Population figures are as reported at the end of September 2026. Numbers are rounded and may be revised as new transactions are registered. This report is for information only and is not investment advice.

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